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‘We do not recommend that pregnant patients suffer with untreated pain or fever.’

BRENNA HUGHES, *Duke University School of Medicine*

Medical world aghast at Trump’s claims

No evidence pregnant women should forgo Tylenol over supposed autism link

By Elizabeth Cooney, Theresa Gaffney, and Annalisa Merelli
STAT

Federal health officials are telling Americans no, they shouldn’t take Tylenol during pregnancy for fear of autism and yes, they should try a drug used in cancer care to treat children who have developed

autism. The medical world disagrees.

“We were actually pretty alarmed by some of the output that was coming from the administration,” Marketa Wills, chief executive and medical director of the American Psychiatric Association, said in an interview. At a remarkable

White House briefing on Monday, President Trump and his top health and science officials said Tylenol use in pregnancy caused some cases of autism in children and said leucovorin, a form of vitamin B9, could treat the disease.

The event has drawn a flood of pushback from medical societies, autism organizations, and pediatric experts through official statements, interviews, and social media. Much more research is needed on the

claims about Tylenol and leucovorin in particular, experts emphasized.

Until more research is conducted, Wills recommends doctors rely on professional societies, peer-reviewed research in medical journals, and resources such as UpToDate and the Washington Manual for guidance on talking with patients.

John Whyte, CEO of the American
PREGNANCY, Page A10

Employers wary of new fee on H-1B visas

\$100,000 proposal could have a big impact in Mass.

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

President Trump’s proposed \$100,000 fee for H-1B visa applications for highly skilled foreign workers is supposed to protect jobs for Americans. But some experts say it will have an outsized effect on Massachusetts, because some of the state’s most prominent employers are reliant on the visas for talent.

Nearly every major player in the knowledge economy of Greater Boston relies on foreign-born workers, from financial services giants Fidelity and State Street, to tech leaders Analog Devices and PTC, to universities and hospitals.

The H-1B program, started in 1990, is supposed to help businesses recruit exceptional foreign talent when they’re not able to find US workers with similar skills. But it has also been the subject of criticism from people who say the visa program has been abused by companies that end up paying foreign workers less than their US-born counterparts.

More than 12,000 new or renewed H-1B visas were issued to about 2,000 Massachusetts companies during the 2025 fiscal year, according to data from the US Citizenship and Immigration Services. Dave Gulley, professor of economics at Bentley University, argues that if it becomes more expensive to employ such workers, some Massachusetts companies may end up hiring less qualified domestic applicants.

VISAS, Page A7

Shutdown could test Trump’s approach on Democrats

By Catie Edmondson
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump’s decision this week to abruptly cancel a meeting with top Democrats aimed at averting a government shutdown within days highlighted the toxic relationship helping drive Congress and the White House toward a crisis.

With a Republican governing trifecta, Trump has adopted a go-it-alone approach at the dawn of his second term, freezing out Democrats and never once inviting their leaders to the White House for negotiations or anything else.

With Democrats opposing him at every turn, the president has been able to rely exclusively on Republicans to push through his big priorities, including enacting a major tax cut and domestic policy bill, clawing back billions in congressionally approved spending, and winning confirmation of his nominees.

That will not be the case when it comes to funding the government, which Congress must do by Tuesday to avoid a shutdown.

Because Republicans have only a narrow majority in the Senate, passing a government spending bill that can win the necessary 60 votes de-

SHUTDOWN, Page A4



PHOTOS BY ANDREW BURKE-STEVENSON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

The Beverly Middle School Balch team celebrated Amanda Neal’s game-tying homer last weekend. Momball began in 1999.

A mother of a tournament

Annual softball — Momball — games bring Beverly together for more than just fun



The games are competitive, with high energy coming from the field and the stands.

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

BEVERLY

Momball weekend really begins on Thursday, a day before the first softball games, with what’s come to be known as “Shenanigan Night.” This year, for example, the Beverly Middle School moms piled into a camper, drove around town, and gently vandalized the houses of the captains of the Momball softball team for every other school in Beverly. Melanie Pyle taped a paint roller to the end of an electric leaf blower and put a roll of toilet paper on it.

“Imagine all that mom energy and creativity going into something called ‘Shenanigan Night,’” she said in a tone that implied you should now shake your head.

This whole thing, Momball, is full of mom energy and creativity and shenanigans, not to mention competition and camaraderie, family and community, and on and on and on in the best possible way.

For 25 years now, it’s worked, and worked again, the simplest of ideas that has become the most important community event for this North Shore city of just over 42,000 people — the moms from each school in town play each other in a weekend-long softball tournament that has

MOMBALL, Page A7

Future uncertain for home hospital stays

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

Paula Ward’s phone rang at 2:08 a.m., waking her up on the couch in her apartment in South Boston. It was her nurse.

Ward’s oxygen levels had dropped, the nurse said, explaining the early morning call. She asked Ward to clamp a small device to the end of her finger to check her oxygen saturation, or percentage of oxygen in her blood. It was back in the normal range and the nurse hung up. Ward, 71, fell back asleep.

Health care providers at Mass General Brigham monitor Ward’s vitals 24 hours a day as she recovers at home from a

urinary tract infection that landed her in the intensive care unit. In the past, she would have been kept in the hospital after leaving the ICU, but now she’s one of dozens of MGB patients participating each day in the Home Hospital program, which allows people with certain conditions to recover at home.

“It’s like a dream come true,” Ward said during her morning check-in with an MGB paramedic. “I won the lottery.”

Patients like Ward say they eat better, sleep better, feel better, and ultimately heal better in the comfort of their homes,
HOME HOSPITAL, Page A10

SHOOTER HITS ICE LOCATION



JULIO CORTEZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

One detainee in a transport van was killed and two were injured in the sniper attack in Dallas on Wednesday. Above, law enforcement agents looked around the roof of an apartment building near the scene. A suspect was arrested; the attack motivation wasn’t known. **A2.**



Nuts! Bolts

The MBTA approved a new disciplinary system for drivers parked or stopped in bus lanes. **B1.**

Bill Russell now has a bridge named after him, the former North Washington Street Bridge. **B1, C4.**

An Israeli airstrike near a market killed nearly two dozen Palestinians. **A3.**

Garrett Crochet pitched brilliantly as the Red Sox won another crucial game. **C1.**

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